United Nations A/HRC/WG.6/53/IRL/1

General Assembly

Distr.: General
17 August 2026

Original: English

Human Rights Council
Working Group on the Universal Periodic Review
Fifty-third session
Geneva, 2–13 November 2026

National report submitted pursuant to Human Rights Council resolutions 5/1 and 16/21*

Ireland

* The present document is being issued without formal editing.

Please recycle

I. Introduction

1. Ireland is pleased to participate in the fourth cycle of the Universal Periodic Review (UPR) and welcomes the opportunity for continued engagement with the United Nations Human Rights Council. Ireland values the UPR as an important mechanism for peer dialogue, accountability and the exchange of good practice in the promotion and protection of human rights. Through this report, Ireland seeks to demonstrate its commitment to the realisation and advancement of human rights through legislative reform, policy development and enhanced institutional arrangements. Over this period, Ireland has also actively engaged with international human rights mechanisms, including treaty monitoring bodies and reporting processes. This report outlines developments since the third cycle review, including measures taken to implement supported recommendations and to address ongoing human rights challenges.

II. Methodology and consultation process

2. This report was coordinated by the Department of Children, Disability and Equality and prepared on the basis of contributions from Government Departments and agencies with responsibility for the implementation of Ireland's human rights obligations and recommendations arising from the third cycle UPR.

3. Preparation included stakeholder engagement, including a consultation event in October 2025 attended by representatives of civil society organisations, the Irish Human Rights and Equality Commission, academics, human rights advocates and Government Departments. Discussions focused on civil and political rights, economic, social and cultural rights, the rights of specific groups and cross-cutting human rights issues.

4. The Department of Children, Disability and Equality also commissioned two expert bodies to consult with children and young people between November 2025 and January 2026. A total of 47 children and young people participated across six consultation groups, including young people with disabilities, children and young people living in international protection accommodation, participants in the School Completion Programme, young people in detention, and members of the Government's Child Poverty and Wellbeing Youth Advisory Group. The consultations explored participants' experiences of growing up in Ireland and their views on the realisation of children's rights.

5. Reports from the consultations are included as annexes to this report.

III. Institutional framework for the protection of human rights

A. National human rights institution

6. The Irish Human Rights and Equality Commission (IHREC)[1] is an independent public body, accountable to the Oireachtas, with its mandate set out in the Irish Human Rights and Equality Commission Act 2014. IHREC's funding has increased annually since its establishment. It received €9.7 million in 2025 and has been allocated €10.5 million in 2026, while staffing increased from 62 in December 2020 to 87 in December 2025. IHREC also has a mandate under equality legislation to promote intercultural understanding. Public bodies are also required under the Public Sector Equality and Human Rights Duty to have regard to equality and human rights issues in performing their functions.

B. Ratification of core human rights treaties

7. Since the 2021 review, Ireland has continued to engage with its commitments to progress outstanding ratifications of human rights treaties, where appropriate. Ireland acceded to the Optional Protocol to the United Nations Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (UNCRPD) on 31 October 2024, and the Optional Protocol entered into

force for Ireland on 30 November 2024[2]. Ireland continues to advance implementation of the UNCRPD through policy and legislative measures outlined in this report.

8. Ireland remains committed to ratifying the Optional Protocol to the Convention against Torture and Other Cruel, Inhuman or Degrading Treatment or Punishment (OPCAT) and is putting in place the necessary legislative framework. The General Scheme of the Inspection of Places of Detention Bill was approved by Government in June 2022[3], and drafting work is underway with a view to publication later in 2026. The legislation will reform the Office of the Inspector of Prisons so that it can assume the role of National Preventive Mechanism (NPM) in the justice sector, while also providing for the designation of NPMs in other sectors, enabling ratification of OPCAT. IHREC is designated in the General Scheme as the coordinating body of the multi-member NPM.

9. Measures now in place are sufficient to address previously identified barriers to ratification of the Second Optional Protocol to the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNCRC) on the sale of children, child prostitution and child pornography. Relevant legislative measures include the Criminal Law (Sexual Offences) Act 2017, the Criminal Justice (Victims of Crime) Act 2017 and more recently the Criminal Law (Sexual Offences and Human Trafficking) Act 2024[4]. Ireland will now proceed with the remaining steps required for ratification, subject to Government approval.

10. Ireland intends to ratify the International Convention for the Protection of All Persons from Enforced Disappearance (ICPPED) as soon as practicable. New legislation may be required, though existing legal protections against unlawful detention include Article 40.4.1 of the Constitution and section 15 of the Non-Fatal Offences Against the Person Act 1997. Ireland signed the Optional Protocol to the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (ICESCR) in March 2012 and the question of ratification remains under consideration by Government. Ireland has not signed or ratified the International Convention on the Protection of the Rights of All Migrant Workers and Members of Their Families (ICRMW). In practice, the rights of migrant workers and their families are extensively protected under Irish legislation, the Constitution and European Union law. In addition, their rights are addressed through Ireland's commitments under international human rights instruments to which the State is a party. While there are currently no plans to sign or ratify the ICRMW, the position remains under review.

11. Ireland continues to engage actively with United Nations treaty bodies through periodic reporting and follow-up procedures. This included submission of its Mid-term Follow-up Report under the ICESCR in May 2026 and its Follow-up Report to the Human Rights Committee, together with an updated Common Core Document, in December 2025.

C. Access to justice, policing reform and accountability

12. Ireland recognises the importance of civil legal aid in supporting access to justice, particularly for persons who may otherwise face barriers to vindicating their rights. Progress has been made in reviewing the effectiveness and future direction of the civil legal aid system. An independent Review Group was established in June 2022 to examine the Civil Legal Aid Scheme and recommend reforms[5]. It considered key issues including financial eligibility thresholds, the scope of services provided, and whether the scheme should continue to operate primarily as a family law service. The Review Group's recommendations[6] are currently under consideration, taking into account findings from Ireland's first national legal needs survey, conducted with the support of the European Commission and the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD). Preliminary findings have been published[7] with full results to follow.

13. Ireland has also advanced significant policing reform through the commencement of the Policing, Security and Community Safety Act 2024[8] on 2 April 2025. The Act gives effect to key recommendations of the Commission on the Future of Policing in Ireland and establishes a new framework for policing, security and community safety, aimed at strengthening the performance, accountability and effectiveness of An Garda Síochána (the Irish police force). It provides for a new Policing and Community Safety Authority, replacing the Policing Authority and Garda Síochána Inspectorate; restructures the Garda Síochána

Ombudsman Commission as Fiosrú – the Office of the Police Ombudsman; establishes a new Garda Board; creates an Office of the Independent Examiner of Security Legislation; and provides for a National Office for Community Safety to support implementation of the Government's community safety strategy and Local Community Safety Partnerships[9]. Members have been appointed to all 36 Partnerships, which are developing Local Community Safety Plans. New regulations under the Act also provide for performance, conduct and standards of professional behaviour for Garda members.

D. Civil society

14. Since the 2021 review, Ireland has taken further steps to strengthen civil society participation in public policy development. The National Civic Forum, which was established under Sustainable, Inclusive and Empowered Communities 2019–2024, provides a mechanism for formal dialogue between the State and the community and voluntary sector and supports participative and deliberative approaches to policymaking. The most recent Forum was held in November 2025[10], and the fifth Annual Civic Forum is planned for the fourth quarter of 2026. A successor strategy is scheduled for publication shortly.

15. Civil Society Organisations (CSOs) have played a significant role in the development of national equality strategies. This role was particularly pronounced in the development of the National Action Plan Against Racism 2023–2027, which was developed by an independent Anti-Racism Committee following extensive consultation, and the National Human Rights Strategy for Disabled People 2025–2030, whose development was driven by disabled people and their representative organisations. Civil society and community representatives also contributed to the development of the National LGBTIQ+ Inclusion Strategy II 2024–2028 (NLIS II), the National Traveller and Roma Inclusion Strategy II 2024–2028 (NTRIS II), the National Strategy for Women and Girls 2025–2030, and the forthcoming migrant integration strategy.

16. CSOs also have defined roles in implementation, oversight and monitoring arrangements for a number of these strategies, including the Advisory Committee on Racial Equality and Racism, the Delivery and Monitoring Committee for the National Human Rights Strategy for Disabled People, the NLIS II and NTRIS II Steering Committees, and the National Traveller and Roma Forum. These arrangements support ongoing engagement with stakeholders and provide mechanisms for monitoring implementation and identifying further action required.

17. In December 2023, a two-year project on the engagement of marginalised communities in local decision-making was completed, producing a resource guide, practical tools for local authorities, and training on engagement techniques, intercultural awareness, Public Sector Equality and Human Rights Duty and facilitation skills[11]. Civil society participation locally is also supported through Public Participation Networks[12], with a network in each of the 31 local authority areas and over 18,000 member groups nationwide. Concerns raised by civil society regarding the definition of "political purposes" in the Electoral Act 1997, and its implications for civil society funding, are being examined as part of a review by An Coimisiún Toghcháin[13].

18. The Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade chairs the Human Rights Committee, comprising representatives from Irish civil society and academia as well as officials from the Department, which facilitates formal consultation and open dialogue on human rights aspects of Ireland's foreign policy. This Committee meets several times a year.

IV. Promotion and protection of human rights: Developments, achievements and challenges since third cycle

A. Equality and non-discrimination

National Action Plan Against Racism

19. Ireland continues to implement measures to combat racism and racial discrimination, including through the National Action Plan Against Racism 2023–2027 (NAPAR)[14], which was developed by a wholly independent Anti-Racism Committee, following extensive consultation and an iterative development process, and was launched on 21 March 2023, the UN International Day for the Elimination of Racial Discrimination. The Plan provides an interdepartmental approach to eliminating racism in all its forms in Ireland, including antisemitism, Islamophobia, racism affecting Traveller and Roma communities, and racism affecting people of African descent. It is intended to have a positive impact across minority ethnic communities and faith-based groups, including the Jewish and Islamic communities in Ireland. Two annual reports covering 2023 and 2024 have been published, with the third report due shortly.

20. NAPAR constitutes part of Ireland's efforts to fulfil its obligations under the UN International Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination (ICERD) and the UN Durban Declaration and Programme of Action. In March 2025, Ireland submitted its combined tenth to twelfth periodic State report to the UN Committee on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination[15], providing comprehensive updates on the implementation of ICERD, the domestic legal framework and national legislation.

21. Implementation of NAPAR is supported through dedicated oversight and monitoring arrangements with significant independent and civil society participation. In July 2024, Dr Ebun Joseph was appointed Special Rapporteur on Racial Equality and Racism[16] to monitor progress towards NAPAR's objectives, consider broader matters relating to racial equality, and request information and data from public bodies. The Special Rapporteur's first annual report was published in February 2026[17]. Dr Joseph also chairs the Advisory Committee on Racial Equality and Racism, which has membership from across society and is tasked with monitoring and helping to progress implementation of NAPAR. Funding is also provided through the Ireland Against Racism Fund, an annual scheme supporting projects and local initiatives to combat racism and promote racial equality. Since 2023, 94 projects have received €3.9 million in funding, including 37 projects awarded €1.5 million in 2025. The funding call closed in July 2026, with successful projects to be announced.

22. NAPAR recognises the intersectionality between racism and other forms of oppression, including those based on gender, socio-economic circumstances, disability, sexuality, religious belief and gender identity. It also supports implementation of related strategies, including NTRIS II, which includes combating racism and discrimination as a key strategic theme.

23. Ireland endorsed the International Holocaust Remembrance Alliance (IHRA) working definition of antisemitism in January of 2025[18]. The current Programme for Government includes commitments to give effect to the EU Council Declaration on Fostering Jewish Life and Combating Antisemitism and the IHRA definition.

Hate speech and hate crime

24. Legislative reforms are being supported by operational policing, victim support, community engagement and online regulatory mechanisms to address hate crime, incitement to hatred and harmful communications. The Criminal Justice (Hate Offences) Act 2024[19] provides for increased penalties where certain offences are motivated by hatred, or where hatred is demonstrated because of certain identity characteristics, including race, colour, nationality, religion, national or ethnic origin, descent, disability, gender, sex characteristics and sexual orientation. Incitement to hatred remains criminalised under the Prohibition of Incitement to Hatred Act 1989[20], while the Harassment, Harmful Communications and Related Offences Act 2020[21] applies to harmful online and offline communications. Online

harms that do not meet the threshold for criminal prosecution may be addressed through regulatory and oversight mechanisms, including the statutory functions of Coimisiún na Meán and the EU Digital Services framework.

25. An Garda Síochána investigates all reported hate crimes and provides support to victims through the criminal justice process. It prohibits racial profiling and unjustified use of diversity or minority grounds in informing policing policy or activity. A network of 586 trained Garda Diversity Officers is in place nationwide to provide reassurance, build trust, and address concerns, and Gardaí continue to engage with advocacy groups to support minority and diverse communities.

Women's rights and gender equality

26. Ireland continues to advance gender equality through policy, legislative and practical measures addressing participation, care responsibilities, workplace equality, childcare and women's representation in public life. Ireland engaged substantively with the UN Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women during its eighth periodic review in 2025[22], its first review since 2017. The Committee's recommendations will inform ongoing work across Government. Ireland also reaffirmed its commitment to the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action at the Beijing+30 High-Level Meeting[23].

27. The whole-of-government National Strategy for Women and Girls 2025–2030[24] was launched in November 2025. The Strategy aims to support the participation of all women and girls in a gender-equal society, including by reducing inequalities, promoting equal opportunities and addressing discrimination. It builds on the previous strategy and is being implemented through two Action Plans. Work on this first Action Plan has been guided by an Interdepartmental Committee, which has provided appropriate Government and State Agency input, with the National Women's Council supporting co-design. A Monitoring Committee, comprising members drawn from stakeholder organisations, will support implementation, develop indicators, monitor progress and identify any barriers.

28. Measures to support work-life balance and caring responsibilities have been extended. The Work Life Balance and Miscellaneous Provisions Act 2023[25] introduced entitlements including leave for medical care purposes, the right to request flexible working for parents and carers, the right to request remote working for all employees, and five days of domestic violence leave in any 12-month period. Parents each have an individual entitlement to nine weeks of Parent's Leave within the first two years of a child's life, while parental leave has been extended from 18 to 26 weeks and may be taken up until the child reaches 12 years of age.

29. Ireland's commitment to gender equality is further reflected in its international development cooperation. Guided by a human rights-based approach and Ireland's development policy, A Better World[26], Ireland promotes gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls as a cross-cutting priority across its development and humanitarian assistance. This includes support for preventing and responding to gender-based violence, advancing sexual and reproductive health and rights, girls' education, women's leadership and economic empowerment, and implementing Ireland's Fourth National Action Plan on Women, Peace and Security[27]. Through sustained partnerships with women's rights organisations and feminist movements internationally, Ireland supports locally led, inclusive and transformative action to advance gender equality and uphold the rights of women and girls across its foreign policy.

30. Childcare supports continue to be expanded, with the allocation for Early Learning and Childcare increasing from approximately €638 million in 2021 to €1.48 billion in Budget 2026. The National Childcare Scheme[28] provides financial supports towards early learning and care, including income-related subsidies, with adjustments introduced in 2026 to increase thresholds and supports for multiple children. The Early Childhood Care and Education programme provides a free two-year preschool scheme for children aged approximately 3-5 years. Core Funding has been expanded, with participating providers subject to fee management measures, and the Access and Inclusion Model supports children with disabilities or additional needs in preschool settings.

31. Measures have been introduced to support women's participation in political life. Legislative provisions include maternity leave for local authority members and members of both Houses of the Oireachtas[29]. Since February 2023, qualified political parties contesting Dáil elections are required to have at least 40% women candidates and at least 40% men candidates. Women represented 25% of those elected to Dáil Éireann in 2024, compared with 23% in 2020. In local government, women accounted for 31.4% of candidates in the 2024 local elections, compared with 28.4% in 2019.

Workplace equality and anti-discrimination law

32. Equality and anti-discrimination protections in employment and access to goods and services are being reviewed and developed, alongside measures to address gender pay gaps and improve women's representation in senior leadership. Ireland's equality legislation prohibits discrimination in employment and in the provision of goods and services on nine grounds: gender, civil status, family status, age, race, religion, disability, sexual orientation and membership of the Traveller community. The Employment Equality Acts and Equal Status Acts are under review[30] to examine their functioning and effectiveness in combating discrimination and promoting equality; a General Scheme was published in 2024 and the Joint Oireachtas Committee on Children and Equality issued its report on the scheme in October 2025[31]. Drafting work is underway in relation to developing a legislative bill with due regard to the recommendations of the report.

33. Measures are also being taken to promote gender balance in senior leadership. Since the establishment of the Balance for Better Business initiative in 2018, women's representation on company boards has increased, with female board representation in ISEQ20 companies reaching 42%. Ireland has transposed the EU Directive on improving gender balance on the boards of listed companies, requiring relevant listed companies to achieve at least 40% representation of the under-represented sex among non-executive directors.

34. Gender pay gap reporting is being delivered on a phased basis under the Gender Pay Gap Information Act 2021[32]. Reporting began in 2022 for organisations with over 250 employees and extended in 2024 to organisations with over 150 employees. Ireland opened its Gender Pay Gap Portal[33] for employer reporting in November 2025. Information collected through the Portal is intended to support analysis of the drivers of the gender pay gap and the development of targeted sector-specific initiatives. Ireland is also transposing the EU Pay Transparency Directive.

LGBTIQ+ rights

35. Ireland is taking forward a whole-of-government framework to remove structural barriers and challenges affecting LGBTIQ+ people. The National LGBTIQ+ Inclusion Strategy II 2024–2028[34] and its first two-year Action Plan 2025–2026 were launched in June 2025. The Strategy seeks to support a safe, fair and inclusive Ireland where people can live healthy and fulfilling lives regardless of sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, or sex characteristics. Implementation is structured around four pillars: Safety, Health and Wellbeing, Participation and Inclusion, and Equality and Non-Discrimination, and adopts a whole-of-life-cycle approach to address challenges faced by LGBTIQ+ people of all ages. Implementation is overseen by an NLIS II Steering Committee, comprising representatives of Government Departments, State agencies and CSOs, particularly those representing LGBTIQ+ people. Progress updates and a 2025 Annual Report have been published.

36. Legislative measures are being developed to address conversion practices. The Programme for Government 2025 commits to advancing legislation to ban conversion practices, to protect individuals from harmful practices while ensuring appropriate services for those with concerns relating to sexual orientation and gender identity are not adversely affected. This work is informed by research published in February 2023[35], which found that conversion practices occur in Ireland and confirmed the harm caused to those subjected to them.

37. Measures are also being advanced to address the legacy of historical criminalisation. On 10 June 2026, amendments to the Criminal Law, Civil Law and Defence (Miscellaneous

Provisions) Bill 2026[36] were moved to provide for an application-based scheme to disregard certain historical convictions and other determinations relating to consensual homosexual activity.

Traveller and Roma inclusion

38. Ireland recognises that Travellers and Roma continue to experience discrimination and socio-economic disadvantage and has taken measures to promote equality, inclusion and participation. The National Traveller and Roma Inclusion Strategy II 2024–2028[37] (NTRIS II) and its first Action Plan 2024–2026 were approved by Government and announced in July 2024. The Strategy provides a whole-of-government framework covering areas including education, employment, health, accommodation, participation, equality and inclusion. Its nine themes include associated outcomes, actions and indicators. Implementation is overseen by a Steering Committee comprising representatives of relevant Government Departments, State agencies and CSOs and supported by thematic subcommittees. The first NTRIS II Annual Report, covering 2025, has been published to support monitoring of progress. An annual Traveller and Roma Forum supports community engagement in implementation.

39. Accommodation remains a key strategic theme. Actions include implementation of the 2019 Traveller Accommodation Expert Review recommendations[38], with oversight provided by a Programme Board with Traveller representation. Between 2020 and 2025, over €160 million was drawn down by local authorities for Traveller-specific accommodation, including €125 million in capital expenditure and €37.9 million in current expenditure, supporting new and refurbished halting sites, group housing schemes, maintenance and related supports. Ireland's national housing plan, Delivering Homes, Building Communities 2025–2030, also includes continued investment in Traveller-specific accommodation alongside social housing delivery.

40. The Strategy includes actions on combating racism and discrimination, culture, heritage and identity, and places a stronger focus on Roma inclusion than its predecessor. These include awareness-raising on rights and routes of complaint, measures to promote Traveller and Roma culture and identity, Roma-specific actions on health, education, accommodation and employment, and continued funding for Roma-specific programmes and organisations. A minimum standard for public sector Traveller and Roma cultural awareness and anti-racism training has been developed in agreement with national Traveller and Roma organisations. A National Traveller Heritage Strategy has also been completed.

41. Under NTRIS II, education is addressed through the Traveller and Roma Education Strategy 2024–2030[39] and its first Implementation Plan 2024–2026, published in July 2024. Measures include 15 Community Link Worker posts to strengthen engagement between schools, families and communities; targeted supports through Delivering Equality of Opportunity in Schools, a national programme aimed at tackling educational disadvantage, the Home School Community Liaison Scheme; and inclusion initiatives such as Creative Clusters which brings together schools and the arts and cultural sector. Governance structures, including a Traveller and Roma Education Strategy Oversight Group and a Traveller and Roma Education Forum, have been established to monitor progress and support ongoing engagement. While educational outcomes have improved, gaps remain in retention and progression to Leaving Certificate level.

42. Measures are being taken to improve employment and public sector participation. The second iteration of the Civil Service Traveller and Roma Placement Programme[40] in 2025 will result in 20 assignments across 12 Departments and agencies, with the majority of the assignments commencing in March 2026. A pilot to increase Traveller and Roma uptake of the Work Placement Experience Programme in public sector organisations has also been launched, alongside a target to increase participation in the private sector. The Traveller and Roma Local Employment Initiative[41] is being expanded to include Roma communities, with a national coordinator[42] to support rollout.

43. Health and wellbeing is also a strategic theme, with actions linked to the National Traveller Health Action Plan, the forthcoming Roma Health Action Plan, and the Traveller and Roma Education Strategy. NTRIS II takes an intersectional approach, including consideration of the social determinants of health, and includes actions supporting Traveller

and Roma women's community engagement and awareness of domestic, sexual and gender-based violence. A Traveller Mental Health Specialist Group was established in January 2026[43] under Sharing the Vision: Ireland's Mental Health Policy 2020–2030 to develop Ireland's first co-produced Traveller Mental Health Action Plan by the end of 2026[44]. The Group includes Traveller organisations, Departmental and Health Service Executive (HSE) representatives, experts, professionals and Traveller community members with lived experience.

Rights of people with disabilities

44. Ireland has taken further steps to advance the rights and inclusion of disabled people through the launch of the National Human Rights Strategy for Disabled People 2025–2030[45] in September 2025. Developed through an extensive consultation process led by the National Disability Authority[46], and informed by disabled people, Disabled Persons' Organisations, families, carers, disability organisations and seldom-heard groups, the Strategy provides a whole-of-government framework to support implementation of the UNCRPD. Consultation included 34 focus groups with 211 participants, 18 interviews, five public consultation events, 85 written and video submissions, and 484 survey responses. The Strategy is structured around five thematic pillars: Inclusive Learning and Education; Employment; Independent Living and Active Participation in Society; Wellbeing and Health; and Transport and Mobility. It includes 23 commitments and will be delivered through three Programme Plans of Action setting out priority actions, delivery responsibilities and indicators.

45. Delivery and monitoring structures have been co-designed with stakeholders to support oversight and accountability. Oversight is provided through the Cabinet Committee on Disability, supported by senior officials and the Disability Unit in the Department of the Taoiseach. A Delivery and Monitoring Committee[47] includes representation from Disabled Persons' Organisations and other disability stakeholders, ensuring that disabled people and their representative organisations continue to have a role in monitoring implementation.

46. The first Programme Plan of Action covers 2025–2026[48] supports implementation of the UNCRPD. Commitments include education, employment, independent living, participation, health and wellbeing, supported decision-making and accessible transport.

47. A public consultation to inform the review of the Disability Act 2005 was launched in June 2026[49], inviting disabled people, families, carers, representative groups and Disabled Persons' Organisations to participate. The review will examine the Act against Ireland's obligations under the UNCRPD, including whether legislative, policy or research recommendations are required.

48. Ireland has implemented a major reform of its law on decision-making capacity through the full commencement of the Assisted Decision-Making (Capacity) Act 2015 in April 2023[50], supporting closer alignment with the UNCRPD. The adult wardship system has now been replaced with a rights-based supported decision-making framework that places individuals at the centre of decisions affecting them and provides supports to persons with capacity difficulties to retain as much control as possible over their own affairs. The Decision Support Service[51], established under the Act, supports people who may have difficulty making decisions without assistance through tiered decision-support arrangements, helping to ensure that their will and preferences are respected.

Migrant integration and social inclusion

49. Policy measures are being developed to support migrant integration and improve access to services for refugees and international protection applicants. The previous Migrant Integration Strategy concluded in 2021, and the Programme for Government 2025 commits to developing a new National Migration and Integration Strategy, informed by a 2023 national consultation[52] on the migrant experience in Ireland and expected to be published in 2026. Refugees, international protection applicants and beneficiaries of temporary protection are supported through the HSE Refugee and Applicants Seeking Protection Service Delivery Model, which aims to provide more consistent pathways to essential health services.

50. Ireland has continued to implement national strategies to address poverty and promote social inclusion. The Roadmap for Social Inclusion 2020–2025 was a whole-of-government

strategy aimed at reducing consistent poverty to 2% or less and making Ireland one of the most socially inclusive countries in the European Union. While the 2% target was not achieved, the rate reduced over the lifetime of the Strategy and 73 of its 81 commitments were delivered. A successor Roadmap for Social Inclusion 2026–2030[53] was published in May 2026 following public consultation, with 63 cross-Government actions across income supports, employment, housing, education, health, transport, childcare and services. Progress will be measured against 25 high-level indicators and reported through annual Progress Reports, with oversight from a senior cross-Government Steering Group chaired by the Minister for Social Protection, with community and voluntary sector representation.

B. Protection from violence, exploitation and abuse

Domestic, sexual and gender-based violence

51. Ireland has strengthened its policy, institutional and legislative response to domestic, sexual and gender-based violence (DSGBV). Zero Tolerance: the Third National Strategy on Domestic, Sexual and Gender-Based Violence 2022–2026[54] was launched in June 2022 and is implemented through action plans. The current 2025–2026 Implementation Plan[55] contains 95 actions under four pillars: prevention, protection, prosecution and policy coordination, and includes key performance indicators and monitoring arrangements. A successor strategy for 2027–2031 is under development in close collaboration with the DSGBV sector and informed by the experiences of victims and survivors.

52. In 2024, Ireland established Cuan[56], the dedicated statutory agency for DSGBV, which became operational on 1 January 2024[57] and coordinates implementation of the Zero Tolerance Strategy. Cuan supports victim services, including safe accommodation and helplines, service standards, awareness-raising and research[58]. Funding to support Cuan and DSGBV services increased from €59 million in 2024 to almost €80 million in Budget 2026. By end-2026, 94 safe houses and 193 refuge units are expected to be completed, bringing total safe accommodation to 287 units, with 50 further refuge units under construction. In 2025, €3.2 million was allocated to support service expansion and innovation, including counselling for adolescent victims and survivors, improved access for marginalised groups, increased helpline capacity, training for DSGBV organisation, and perpetrator programmes.

53. Enacted legislative reforms have strengthened protection, prosecution and accountability. The Criminal Justice (Miscellaneous Provisions) Act 2023[59] created standalone offences of stalking and non-fatal strangulation, strengthened harassment law, and increased the maximum sentence for assault causing harm to 10 years. The Criminal Law (Sexual Offences and Human Trafficking) Act 2024[60] strengthened protections for victims in sexual offence trials. The Sex Offenders (Amendment) Act 2023[61] strengthened the supervision and monitoring of sex offenders, and the Family Courts Act 2024[62] provides for dedicated Family Courts. Further legislative measures are at an advanced stage on guardianship, domestic violence judgments, sexual consent, sex-for-rent practices, and Operation Encompass. Amendments to the Criminal Law, Civil Law and Defence (Miscellaneous Provisions) Bill 2026[63] will introduce a presumption of non-disclosure for counselling notes in sexual offence trials, with judicial oversight of disclosure and related protections for other sensitive victims' records.

54. Ireland has taken legislative, health and community-based measures to address female genital mutilation. The Criminal Justice (Female Genital Mutilation) Act 2012[64] criminalises female genital mutilation, and further provisions are included in the General Scheme of the Criminal Law (Sexual Offences, Domestic Violence and International Instruments) Bill 2025[65]. Female genital mutilation is recognised in the Zero Tolerance Strategy as a form of gender-based violence, and responses include HSE-funded treatment services, community outreach and awareness-raising. Ireland is also progressing relevant European Union measures, including transposition of the EU Directive on combating violence against women and domestic violence and consideration of further measures following adoption of the revised EU Victims' Rights Directive. Public awareness campaigns continue to signpost domestic violence supports.

55. Training and practice reforms are being implemented across justice and policing agencies. An Garda Síochána has introduced mandatory domestic violence training, and Divisional Protective Services Units are in place in every Garda division to support vulnerable victims and to ensure specialist handling of relevant cases. The Judicial Council has committed to continuous professional learning for judges on DSGBV and family law under the Zero Tolerance Implementation Plan 2025–2026.

Human trafficking

56. Ireland's response to trafficking in human beings is guided by the Third National Action Plan to Prevent and Combat Human Trafficking 2023–2027[66], launched in November 2023. The Plan provides a whole-of-government and victim-centred framework across the pillars of prevention, protection, prosecution and policy coordination and is implemented in cooperation with statutory bodies, law enforcement authorities and civil society organisations.

57. Implementation measures include strengthening awareness and training for frontline professionals who may encounter victims, improving coordination between relevant authorities, and enhancing victim identification and referral mechanisms. Particular attention is given to groups at heightened risk of trafficking and exploitation, including women, children, separated children and migrant workers. Child-specific actions include training professionals in contact with children to identify indicators of trafficking, embedding the best interests of the child in training and practice, strengthening cooperation between Tusla, An Garda Síochána and the HSE, and reviewing arrangements where a child goes missing from care. Work is also underway to transpose the EU Directive on preventing and combating trafficking in human beings and protecting its victims.

C. Detention, oversight and penal reform

58. Ireland remains committed to ratifying OPCAT. The Inspection of Places of Detention Bill will provide the legislative framework necessary for ratification, including arrangements for a multi-member National Preventive Mechanism.

59. Prison safeguards are being strengthened through training, oversight and operational standards. Human rights training is provided to new recruits to the Irish Prison Service, including a dedicated module on prison oversight, which includes discussion of the Convention against Torture and the Council of Europe Committee for the Prevention of Torture. Measures are in place to align prison practice with the United Nations Standard Minimum Rules for the Treatment of Prisoners (Mandela Rules) on solitary confinement, including a requirement that prisoners spend a minimum of two hours out of cell daily. Restricted regimes may apply for medical reasons, the protection of vulnerable prisoners, or the maintenance of good order, and are subject to regular review. Where appropriate, prisoners may be transferred to other institutions so that a restricted regime is no longer necessary.

60. Prison overcrowding and related penal reform issues remain a focus of ongoing work. The Irish prison estate is experiencing sustained overcrowding, including in the dedicated remand prison at Cloverhill; as of 10 March 2026, the system was operating at 124% of total maximum capacity. A cross-agency Prison Overcrowding Response Group, established in 2023, continues to meet regularly. Ireland is pursuing a dual approach of expanding prison capacity and supporting non-custodial sanctions, including community sanctions to reduce offending, divert people from imprisonment and support rehabilitation. A record capital investment of €527 million is being provided to the Irish Prison Service under the National Development Plan, with a target of delivering more than 1,500 additional spaces by 2031. Since 2024, 232 new spaces have been constructed, with a further 65 planned in 2026. Oversight mechanisms include the independent Inspector of Prisons, with statutory responsibility for prison inspections. Work is also underway to modernise Prison Visiting Committees[67] and develop a new prisoner complaints system.

61. The mental health and addiction needs of persons in prison are being addressed through interdepartmental reform and service planning. The High-Level Taskforce on Mental

Health and Addiction[68] reported in September 2022 and made 61 recommendations to strengthen links between services and improve supports for persons in the criminal justice system with mental health or addiction issues. Implementation is overseen by an interdepartmental Steering Committee, and the second annual progress report was published in July 2025[69]. Work is ongoing to develop psychiatric intensive care and rehabilitation units, and a new medical unit at Mountjoy Prison. The Irish Prison Service Health Needs Assessment, published in 2023[70], made 60 recommendations to strengthen healthcare services in prisons and implementation is ongoing.

D. Transitional justice and historical redress

Action Plan for Survivors and Former Residents of Mother and Baby and County Home Institutions

62. Since the 2021 review, Ireland has continued to advance measures relating to historical institutional abuse, identity rights and redress through implementation of the Action Plan for Survivors and Former Residents of Mother and Baby and County Home Institutions. The Action Plan[71] sets out the Government's response to the Commission of Investigation into Mother and Baby and County Home Institutions, whose final report was published in January 2021 and was followed by a State apology. Six of the seven major commitments are now delivered, while the seventh, the National Centre for Research and Remembrance, is well underway. Key actions include the appointment of a Special Advocate for Survivors of Institutional Abuse[72] in March 2024 to amplify survivors' voices and promote their collective interests in Government deliberations on matters affecting them; a commemorative grant scheme; free counselling supports; the Birth Information and Tracing legislation; the Mother and Baby Institutions Payment Scheme; and the undertaking of intervention by an independent Office at the former Mother and Baby Institution site in Tuam[73] that involves the forensic excavation, recovery, identification where possible, and dignified re-interment of children's remains.

Birth Information and Tracing Act 2022

63. A significant development since the last review has been the enactment of the Birth Information and Tracing Act 2022[74], which established a right of access to birth certificates, birth and early life information for persons who were adopted, boarded out, the subject of an illegal birth registration, spent time as a child in a Mother and Baby or County Home Institution, or otherwise have questions about their origins. Services under the Act include access to full and unredacted information, tracing services and the Contact Preference Register. To date, over 18,100 information applications, 9,500 tracing applications and 4,400 Contact Preference Register entries have been received. The Act also enables persons affected by incorrect birth registration to have their birth registration corrected, while retaining their lived or social identity if they so wish. A statutory review of the Act is underway.

Mother and Baby Institutions Payment Scheme

64. The Mother and Baby Institutions Payment Scheme Act 2023[75] established the scheme which opened for applications in March 2024[76] and provides financial payments and health supports to eligible applicants in recognition of the circumstances experienced while resident in a Mother and Baby Institution. Since opening, the Scheme has received over 7,300 applications and paid over €79 million. More than 2,100 medical cards have been issued, and over 700 health support payments have been made to applicants living outside the State in lieu of a medical card.

Magdalen Laundries

65. Ireland has also continued to progress redress measures for the Magdalen Laundries. The Magdalen Restorative Justice Ex Gratia Scheme[77] remains open and, to date, €33.4 million has been paid in lump sum awards to 834 applicants, who are also entitled to pension-type payments and an enhanced medical card. In response to the Ombudsman's 2017 report

on the administration of the Scheme, Opportunity Lost, Mary O'Toole SC reviewed cases involving disputes over length of stay in a Magdalen institution and cases where applicants lacked capacity to accept an award. The Report of the Review of the Magdalen Restorative Justice Ex Gratia Scheme was published in March 2026[78].

Residential Institutions

66. The Supports for Survivors of Residential Institutional Abuse Act 2025[79] was passed by the Oireachtas in July 2025. The Act provides ongoing health and education supports to survivors of abuse in residential institutions, including industrial schools and reformatories, and builds on previous State responses, including the establishment of the Commission to Inquire into Child Abuse and the Residential Institutions Redress Board, with expenditure of approximately €1.5 billion. Applications for supports opened in March 2026[80], and an estimated 9,400 survivors may be eligible.

E. Economic, social and cultural rights

Housing / homelessness

67. Since the 2021 review, Ireland has continued to recognise housing as one of the most pressing challenges and has taken steps to address housing shortages, affordability pressures and homelessness. The Government's approach is to increase supply and accelerate delivery of social, affordable and private housing. Delivering Homes, Building Communities 2025–2030[81], published in November 2025, is Ireland's integrated housing and homelessness plan, based on two pillars: activating the supply of 300,000 more homes and supporting people to have a home of their own. Record housing investment is being provided in 2026, with over €9 billion in capital funding and over €2 billion in current funding.

68. Housing delivery has increased. In 2025, 36,284 homes were completed, the highest annual completion figure since the series began in 2011 and a 20% increase on 2024, contributing to 148,995 new homes delivered over the past five years. The plan also includes actions to support vulnerable groups, including continued investment in Traveller-specific accommodation alongside social housing delivery.

69. As a signatory to the Lisbon Declaration on the European Platform on Combating Homelessness, Ireland has committed to working towards ending homelessness by 2030. However, significant challenges remain. Ireland's housing policy continues to apply a housing-led approach alongside measures to increase housing supply and support households experiencing, or at risk of, homelessness. A Child and Family Homelessness Action Plan, drafted following public consultation including with children with lived experience, is due to be published shortly. Ireland has allocated €513.5 million for homelessness prevention services and related supports, including tenancy sustainment and Housing First, with an additional €50 million in capital funding for transitional and emergency accommodation.

Education

70. Ireland continues to implement measures to support access, inclusion and equality of opportunity across the education system. Ireland has a constitutional guarantee of free primary education under Article 42.4 of the Constitution, and free post-primary education has been State policy since 1967. The Education (Admission to Schools) Act 2018[82] provides a framework for fair and transparent school enrolment, prohibits charging fees for admission or continued enrolment subject to limited exceptions, and requires schools to state that they will not discriminate on grounds covered by equality legislation. The free schoolbooks scheme has been expanded to pupils in primary, special and post-primary schools in the Free Education Scheme from the 2025/26 school year and the School Meals Programme has expanded significantly, with all primary schools eligible for hot school meals since September 2025.

71. Ireland is taking forward a Schools Reconfiguration for Diversity process to increase multi-denominational primary provision in response to local community preferences. The Framework and Action Plan for Delivery of Increased Choice for Parents on Education

Provision at Primary Level[83] supports increased parental choice regarding patronage and ethos. All State-funded primary schools follow a common national curriculum and are subject to the same Department of Education rules and regulations, regardless of ethos.

72. Targeted measures support inclusion and address educational disadvantage. The Delivering Equality of Opportunity in Schools (DEIS)[84] programme provides additional resources to schools serving communities with concentrated educational disadvantage, including through the Home School Community Liaison and School Completion Programmes. The DEIS model, expanded in 2022[85], recognises disadvantage affecting Travellers and Roma, and children residing in homeless or international protection accommodation. The DEIS Strategy to 2035[86], published in March 2026, sets out a whole-system, evidence-based approach to educational disadvantage. It includes DEIS Plus, which provides enhanced supports to schools with the highest concentrations of educational disadvantage. Additional measures include educational welfare supports, a national school attendance campaign and enhanced out-of-school provision.

73. Students with special educational needs are supported through special education teaching supports, special needs assistants, special classes and special school provision. Almost 1,450 new special classes have been sanctioned and sixteen new special schools established over the last four years, with forward planning continuing to meet increasing need.

74. Measures are also being taken to support Traveller, Roma and migrant learners. The Traveller and Roma Education Strategy 2024–2030[87] and its first Implementation and Action Plan 2024–2026 set out actions to improve access, participation and outcomes. Migrant children, including children of international protection applicants, children of migrant workers and unaccompanied minors, can access primary and post-primary education on a similar basis to Irish nationals. Supports include the Tusla Education Support Service, Regional Education and Language Teams, and resources supporting linguistic and cultural diversity.

75. Measures are also in place to support inclusion in higher education and digital learning. The National Access Plan 2022–2028[88] identifies priority groups that remain underrepresented, including socio-economically disadvantaged students, Traveller and Roma students, and students with disabilities, including intellectual disabilities. Measures include alternative pathways between further and higher education, fee support for part-time study through the Part-time Fee Scheme for Specified Undergraduate Courses, and PATH 4 Phase 2 courses for people with intellectual disabilities[89], which have been extended to 2028. The Digital Strategy for Schools to 2027[90] is also being implemented, with ICT grant funding for pupils and students in DEIS schools to support access to digital learning.

Health

76. Ireland continues to improve access to healthcare, address health inequalities and support the progressive development of universal health coverage. Sláintecare remains central to developing a universal health and social care system, with access based on need rather than ability to pay. The latest plan, The Path to Universal Healthcare – Sláintecare and Programme for Government 2025+[91], was published in May 2025 and sets out an integrated reform programme for 2025–2027, focused on improving access, service quality and capacity. Increased investment and staffing are intended to support service capacity, with total health expenditure rising by 112% between 2012 and 2025 and 152,218 whole-time equivalent staff employed in the health service as of January 2026.

77. Measures have been expanded to support sexual and reproductive health. The Free Contraception Scheme[92], launched in September 2022, now covers eligible women aged 17–35, and plans are being progressed to improve access through pharmacies. The National Sexual Health Strategy 2025–2035[93] was launched in June 2025. The national Home STI Testing service has expanded access to testing, with approximately 10,000 free home testing kits ordered each month, while a national HIV pre-exposure prophylaxis (PrEP) programme provides free medication through approved HSE services. Work also continues to address period poverty through period dignity supports.

78. The Health (Regulation of Termination of Pregnancy) Act 2018[94] has been in operation since January 2019 and provides for lawful termination of pregnancy in specified circumstances, including without restriction up to 12 weeks of pregnancy. The Health (Termination of Pregnancy Services) (Safe Access Zones) Act 2024[95] was signed into law in May 2024 and commenced in October 2024. The Act provides for safe access zones to protect safe and private access to lawful termination of pregnancy services.

79. Mental health policy and legislative reform have also advanced. Sharing the Vision 2020–2030[96], Ireland's national mental health policy, continues to be implemented to strengthen mental health promotion, prevention, early intervention and specialist services. Ireland's new strategy to reduce suicide and self-harm, Connecting for Life 2026–2035[97], was launched in May 2026, and work is underway to develop its first implementation plan. The Mental Health Act 2026[98], enacted in May 2026, provides for a more rights-based and person-centred approach, regulates inpatient and community mental health services, revises provisions on capacity and consent to treatment, and strengthens safeguards for persons accessing inpatient treatment.

Children's rights

80. Ireland continues to advance children's rights through policy, legislative and institutional measures to embed the UNCRC in public decision-making, strengthen child participation, and improve protection and support for children and young people. Young Ireland: the National Policy Framework for Children and Young People 2023–2028[99] provides the overarching cross-government approach to children's rights and wellbeing and is directly aligned with Ireland's responsibilities under the UNCRC. A progress report on implementation up to the end of 2024 has been published. Work is underway on a Child Rights Impact Assessment Toolkit, and research has been commissioned following the UN Committee on the Rights of the Child's 2023 Concluding Observations to examine Ireland's legislative compliance with the Convention.

81. Child poverty is a specific focus under Young Ireland, which identifies "Spotlights" to support time-bound, cross-government action on significant challenges affecting children and young people. In September 2025, Government published a new National Child Poverty Target to reduce child consistent poverty to 3% or less by the end of 2030[100]. The Child Poverty and Well-being Programme Office[101], established in the Department of the Taoiseach in 2023, coordinates Government action to reduce child poverty and foster children's wellbeing including through the annual budgetary process. Priority areas have included income support and joblessness, early learning and childcare, the cost of education and family homelessness.

82. Ireland continues to strengthen the participation of children and young people in public decision-making. The Participation of Children and Young People in Decision-Making Action Plan 2024–2028[102] aims to embed meaningful participation across Government and public services. Implementation is supported by Comhairle na nÓg[103] (Youth Councils) in each local authority area, the National Participation Office and Hub na nÓg[104], the national centre of excellence on child and youth participation. Investment in youth services continues to support children and young people, including those experiencing disadvantage or exclusion, with €94.1 million allocated in 2026 for targeted youth services, youth employability supports, youth information services and local youth clubs.

83. Measures are in place to support children in vulnerable situations within the education system, including educational welfare support for children living in homeless accommodation and for children in care. These measures are complemented by DEIS supports, expanded special education provision, and guidance published in December 2024 on behaviours of concern and crisis situations in schools[105], which emphasises prevention and early intervention, provides that physical intervention should only be used as a last resort, and states that seclusion should not be used under any circumstances in recognised schools.

84. The Youth Justice Strategy 2021–2027[106] continues to be implemented, with a focus on early intervention, prevention, family support, community engagement and youth diversion. There are 92 Youth Diversion Projects and four Targeted Youth Diversion Projects operating nationwide, providing community-based programmes to divert young people from

anti-social or criminal behaviour. Funding for youth justice measures has almost doubled between 2020 and 2026, including an additional €7.3 million in core Exchequer funding under Budget 2026.

85. Ireland continues to take measures to protect children from sexual exploitation, abuse and online harms. Ireland has ratified the Council of Europe Convention on the Protection of Children against Sexual Exploitation and Sexual Abuse (Lanzarote Convention), transposed the EU Directive on combating the sexual abuse and sexual exploitation of children and child sexual abuse material, and participates in the Lanzarote Convention Committee. Online safety is addressed under the Digital Strategy for Schools to 2027, with Webwise providing resources for schools, teachers, parents and young people. An Garda Síochána has a dedicated Garda National Protective Services Bureau, including the Online Child Exploitation Unit, and the Irish Internet Hotline enables anonymous and confidential reporting of illegal online content, particularly child sexual abuse material. Discussions on the recast EU Child Sexual Abuse Directive and proposed Child Sexual Abuse Regulation are priorities for Ireland during its EU Presidency in the second half of 2026.

86. Measures are also being advanced to improve integrated supports for child victims of sexual abuse. Implementation and expansion of the Barnahus model[107] is underway, bringing together health, medical, child protection, therapeutic and policing services in a child-centred setting. Two Barnahus services are currently operating, Barnahus West and Barnahus South, and work is underway to establish Barnahus East and to develop the legislative, operational and practice reforms required to embed the model on a sustainable basis. Additional funding in 2026 will support further development of the model and the multi-agency approach central to its delivery.

F. Migrants, refugees and international protection

Accommodation reform

87. Since the 2021 review, Ireland has continued to reform its framework for accommodation and supports for applicants for international protection. Since January 2022, over 32,000 new arrivals have placed substantial pressure on the system and required a review of the assumptions underpinning the White Paper to End Direct Provision and Establish a New International Protection Support Service[108], published in 2021. In response, the Government approved a Comprehensive Accommodation Strategy in March 2024[109], which is now being implemented to address immediate accommodation shortfalls while reforming the system over the longer term, including through increased State-owned permanent capacity, upgraded accommodation centres, property acquisition and continued use of emergency accommodation in the short to medium term. It aims to deliver 14,000 State-owned beds by 2028, as part of a system with capacity for up to 35,000 places, while reducing reliance over time on emergency commercial accommodation. The 2025 purchase of the Citywest Hotel and Conference Centre[110] increased State-owned beds in the International Protection Accommodation Service (IPAS) system from 900 in mid-2024 to 4,000.

Current supports and pressures

88. Ireland is currently accommodating over 33,000 people in approximately 310 IPAS centres[111]. The significant increase in demand means that not all applicants can be offered accommodation, and IPAS prioritises available places for women, children and those who are most vulnerable. At present, IPAS remains unable to offer accommodation to all single male applicants. Applicants not offered accommodation receive a weekly allowance of €113.80 and may access day services through NGO partners[112]. IPAS also undertakes outreach to applicants identified as rough-sleeping, prioritising those most vulnerable. Since March 2025, IPAS has reviewed cases of persons awaiting accommodation and made offers to those waiting longest. Through these and other measures, the number of people without accommodation has reduced from over 3,500 to 649.

Monitoring and inspection

89. Monitoring and inspection mechanisms are in place for accommodation for international protection applicants and beneficiaries of temporary protection. IPAS operates complaints mechanisms and carries out unannounced compliance visits, and residents may bring complaints to the Ombudsman or the Ombudsman for Children. Since January 2024, the Health Information and Quality Authority[113] (HIQA) has monitored the quality of permanent IPAS centres under the amended Reception Conditions Regulations, while emergency centres remain subject to separate contractual inspection arrangements. HIQA's 2025 overview report[114] identified improvements in governance, safeguarding and risk management, alongside concerns including overcrowding and health and safety issues. The International Protection Act 2026[115] gives effect to the EU Migration and Asylum Pact, designates HIQA as the monitoring body for accommodation centres, and establishes the Office of the Chief Inspector of Asylum Border Procedures as the independent monitoring mechanism for screening and asylum border procedures.

G. Business and human rights

90. Ireland promotes human rights, environmental protection and sustainable development through trade policy and support for sustainable development provisions in EU trade agreements. Ireland continues to advance implementation of the UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights through development of a second National Action Plan on Business and Human Rights[116]. Ireland is also committed to transposing the EU Corporate Sustainability Due Diligence Directive[117] by July 2028, requiring in-scope companies to undertake risk-based human rights due diligence.

H. Climate and environment

91. Ireland continues to implement its climate action framework through Climate Action Plans[118], statutory adaptation planning and quarterly progress reporting. The Climate Action and Low Carbon Development Act 2021[119] requires annual updates to the Climate Action Plan. Ireland published its second statutory National Adaptation Framework[120] in June 2024 while Climate Action Plan 2025[121] was approved by Government in April 2025. The Framework emphasises just resilience, including the needs of marginalised groups in adaptation policy. In 2025, 13 Sectoral Adaptation Plans were approved by Government, and 31 Local Authority Climate Action Plans published in 2024 also include a strong focus on adaptation.

92. Public participation and community engagement are supported through the National Dialogue on Climate Action[122], Ireland's main initiative for engaging citizens and communities in climate action and awareness, which has engaged over 1,000 stakeholders, including communities most affected by the transition to a carbon-neutral future. It included workshops with women, disabled people and local communities, and these engagements inform Climate Action Plans and wider strategy development.

Notes

1 http://www.ihrec.ie.
2 https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/press-releases/optional-protocol-to-the-convention-on-persons-with-disabilities-to-come-into-force-in-ireland-on-30-november-2024/.
3 https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/press-releases/minister-for-justice-publishes-general-scheme-of-the-inspection-of-places-of-detention-bill/.
4 https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2024/act/28/enacted/en/html.
5 https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/consultations/public-consultation-on-the-review-of-the-civil-legal-aid-scheme/.
6 https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/press-releases/minister-jim-ocallaghan-publishes-historic-review-of-civil-legal-aid-scheme/.

[7] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/press-releases/minister-jim-ocallaghan-notes-the-early-findings-of-irelands-first-legal-needs-survey/.
[8] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2024/act/1/enacted/en/index.html.
[9] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/publications/local-community-safety-partnerships/.
[10] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-rural-and-community-development-and-the-gaeltacht/publications/sustainable-inclusive-and-empowered-communities-a-five-year-strategy-to-support-the-community-and-voluntary-sector-in-ireland-2019-2024/.
[11] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-rural-and-community-development-and-the-gaeltacht/collections/a-guide-for-inclusive-community-engagement-in-local-planning-and-decision-making/.
[12] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-rural-and-community-development-and-the-gaeltacht/policy-information/public-participation-networks/.
[13] https://cdn.electoralcommission.ie/app/uploads/2024/07/08123719/EC_RESEARCH_PROGRAMME_ENG_ACCESSIBLE.pdf.
[14] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/publications/national-action-plan-against-racism/.
[15] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/publications/submission-of-10th-12th-periodic-state-report-to-un-committee-on-the-elimination-of-all-forms-of-racial-discrimination-cerd/.
[16] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/press-releases/minister-joe-obrien-announces-the-appointment-of-the-special-rapporteur-for-the-national-action-plan-against-racism/.
[17] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/press-releases/minister-of-state-colm-brophy-announces-publication-of-the-first-annual-report-of-the-special-rapporteur-for-racism-and-racial-equality-dr-ebun-joseph/.
[18] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-foreign-affairs/press-releases/t%C3%A1naiste-announces-endorsement-of-global-guidelines-for-countering-antisemitism-and-the-ihra-working-definition-of-antisemitism/.
[19] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2024/act/41/enacted/en/.
[20] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/1989/act/19/enacted/en/.
[21] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2020/act/32/enacted/en/.
[22] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/press-releases/minister-for-children-disability-and-equality-welcomes-un-progress-report-on-elimination-of-discrimination-against-women-in-ireland/.
[23] https://www.ireland.ie/en/un/newyork/news-and-speeches/speeches-archive/beijing-30-high-level-meeting/.
[24] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/campaigns/national-strategy-for-women-and-girls-2025-2030/.
[25] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2023/act/8/enacted/en/html.
[26] https://www.ireland.ie/en/irish-aid/news-and-publications/publications/publication-index/a-better-world-irelands-policy-for-international-development/.
[27] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-foreign-affairs/press-releases/t%C3%A1naiste-launches-fourth-national-action-plan-on-women-peace-and-security/.
[28] https://www.ncs.gov.ie/en/.
[29] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2024/act/37/section/4/enacted/en/index.html.
[30] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/publications/the-review-of-the-equality-acts/.
[31] https://www.oireachtas.ie/en/press-centre/press-releases/20251009-joint-committee-on-children-and-equality-publishes-report-on-pre-legislative-scrutiny-of-the-general-scheme-of-the-equality-miscellaneous-provisions-bill-2024/.
[32] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2021/act/20/enacted/en/.
[33] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/publications/gender-pay-gap-portal/.
[34] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/campaigns/national-lgbtiq-inclusion-strategy-ii-2024-2028/.
[35] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/press-releases/minister-ogorman-announces-the-publication-of-the-report-an-exploration-of-conversion-therapy-practices-in-ireland/.
[36] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/press-releases/minister-jim-ocallaghan-secures-government-approval-to-introduce-amendments-to-the-criminal-law-and-civil-law-miscellaneous-provisions-bill-2026/.

[37] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/publications/national-traveller-and-roma-inclusion-strategy-ii-2024-2028-ntris-ii/.
[38] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-housing-local-government-and-heritage/publications/traveller-accommodation-expert-review-programme-board-update/.
[39] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/consultations/traveller-and-roma-education-strategy/.
[40] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/organisation-information/civil-service-traveller-and-roma-placement-programme/.
[41] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/press-releases/minister-foley-announces-the-opening-of-applications-for-the-traveller-and-roma-local-employment-initiative/.
[42] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/publications/open-call-traveller-and-roma-local-employment-initiative-expansion-local-offices-and-national-coordinator/.
[43] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-health/press-releases/minister-for-mental-health-mary-butler-td-announces-the-inaugural-meeting-of-the-national-traveller-mental-health-specialist-group/.
[44] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-health/press-releases/minister-for-mental-health-mary-butler-announces-a-new-consultation-process-to-inform-the-development-of-the-traveller-mental-health-action-plan/.
[45] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/campaigns/the-national-human-rights-strategy-for-disabled-people-2025-2030/.
[46] https://nda.ie/publications/nhrsd-consultation-report.
[47] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-the-taoiseach/press-releases/listening-to-the-voice-of-disabled-people-taoiseach-miche%C3%A1l-martin-chairs-first-meeting-of-delivery-and-monitoring-committee-for-the-national-human-rights-strategy-for-disabled-people-2025-2030/.
[48] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-the-taoiseach/press-releases/listening-to-the-voice-of-disabled-people-taoiseach-miche%C3%A1l-martin-chairs-first-meeting-of-delivery-and-monitoring-committee-for-the-national-human-rights-strategy-for-disabled-people-2025-2030/.
[49] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/consultations/public-consultation-to-inform-the-review-of-the-disability-act-2005/.
[50] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2023/si/205/made/en/print.
[51] https://www.decisionsupportservice.ie/.
[52] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/consultations/public-consultation-to-inform-a-national-strategy-for-migrant-integration/.
[53] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-social-protection/publications/roadmap-for-social-inclusion-2026-2030/.
[54] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/publications/third-national-strategy-on-domestic-sexual-and-gender-based-violence/.
[55] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/publications/zero-tolerance-implementation-plan-20252026/.
[56] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/campaigns/cuan/.
[57] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/press-releases/minister-mcentee-opens-cuan-the-new-statutory-domestic-sexual-and-gender-based-violence-agency/.
[58] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/publications/cuan-publications/.
[59] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2023/act/24/enacted/en/.
[60] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2024/act/28/enacted/en/.
[61] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2023/act/9/enacted/en/.
[62] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2024/act/48/enacted/en/.
[63] https://www.oireachtas.ie/en/bills/bill/2026/1/.
[64] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2012/act/11/enacted/en/.
[65] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/press-releases/minister-jim-ocallaghan-secures-government-approval-to-progress-the-criminal-law-sexual-offences-domestic-violence-and-international-instruments-bill-2025/.
[66] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/publications/third-national-action-plan-to-combat-and-prevent-human-trafficking/.
[67] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/press-releases/minister-for-justice-simon-harris-publishes-the-report-of-the-review-of-prison-visiting-committees/.
[68] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/publications/high-level-taskforce-on-mental-health-and-addiction-2nd-annual-progress-report/.
[69] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-health/press-releases/publication-of-the-second-annual-progress-report-of-the-high-level-taskforce-on-mental-health-and-addiction/.
[70] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/publications/health-needs-assessment-for-the-irish-prison-service/.
[71] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/publications/state-apology-and-

action-plan/.
[72] https://www.specialadvocate.ie/.
[73] https://odait.ie/.
[74] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2022/act/14/enacted/en/.
[75] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2023/act/20/enacted/en/.
[76] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/press-releases/mother-and-baby-institutions-payment-scheme-open-for-applications/.
[77] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/services/the-magdalen-restorative-justice-ex-gratia-scheme/.
[78] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/publications/report-of-the-review-of-the-magdalen-restorative-justice-ex-gratia-scheme/.
[79] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2025/act/7/enacted/en/.
[80] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/publications/supports-for-survivors-of-residential-institutional-abuse/.
[81] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-housing-local-government-and-heritage/publications/delivering-homes-building-communities-2025-2030-an-action-plan-on-housing-supply-and-targeting-homelessness/.
[82] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2018/act/14/enacted/en/.
[83] https://assets.gov.ie/static/documents/09ad91e7/Framework_and_Action_Plan.pdf.
[84] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/policy-information/deis-delivering-equality-of-opportunity-in-schools/.
[85] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/publications/extension-of-deis-to-further-schools/.
[86] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/press-releases/minister-naughton-announces-48-million-investment-in-new-deis-strategy-and-deis-plus-scheme/.
[87] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/consultations/traveller-and-roma-education-strategy/.
[88] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-further-and-higher-education-research-innovation-and-science/publications/national-access-plan-2022-to-2028/.
[89] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-further-and-higher-education-research-innovation-and-science/press-releases/improved-access-for-students-with-an-intellectual-disability-as-minister-harris-launches-9-million-funding/.
[90] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/publications/digital-strategy-for-schools-to-2027/.
[91] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-health/publications/path-to-universal-healthcare-sl%C3%A1intecare-programme-for-government-2025/.
[92] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-health/campaigns/free-contraception-scheme/.
[93] https://www.gov.ie/en/healthy-ireland/policy-information/national-sexual-health-strategy-2025-2035/.
[94] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2018/act/31/enacted/en/.
[95] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2024/act/13/enacted/en/.
[96] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-health/publications/sharing-the-vision-a-mental-health-policy-for-everyone/.
[97] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-health/publications/irelands-strategy-to-reduce-suicide-and-self-harm-connecting-for-life-20262035/.
[98] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2026/act/11/enacted/en/.
[99] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/campaigns/young-ireland/.
[100] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-social-protection/press-releases/taoiseach-miche%C3%A1l-martin-and-minister-dara-calleary-publish-the-new-national-child-poverty-target/.
[101] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-the-taoiseach/campaigns/child-poverty-and-well-being-programme-office/.
[102] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/publications/participation-of-children-and-young-people-in-decision-making-action-plan-2024-2028/.
[103] https://comhairlenanog.ie/.
[104] https://hubnanog.ie/.
[105] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/publications/understanding-behaviours-of-concern-and-responding-to-crisis-situations/.
[106] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-justice-home-affairs-and-migration/publications/youth-justice-strategy-2021-2027/.
[107] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/campaigns/barnahus-ireland/.
[108] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/publications/white-paper-on-ending-direct-provision/.
[109] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/press-releases/government-agrees-new-comprehensive-accommodation-strategy-for-international-protection-applicants/.
[110] https://www.gov.ie/en/international-protection-accommodation-services-ipas/publications/citywest-hotel-and-conference-centre/.

[111] https://www.oireachtas.ie/en/debates/question/2026-03-19/30/.
[112] https://www.oireachtas.ie/en/debates/question/2026-07-07/561/.
[113] https://www.hiqa.ie.
[114] https://www.hiqa.ie/reports-and-publications/key-reports-investigations/monitoring-international-protection.
[115] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2026/act/9/enacted/en/.
[116] https://www.ireland.ie/en/dfa/role-policies/international-priorities/human-rights/business-and-human-rights/.
[117] https://enterprise.gov.ie/en/what-we-do/the-business-environment/corporate-sustainability-due-diligence/.
[118] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-climate-energy-and-the-environment/publications/climate-action-plan/.
[119] https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2021/act/32/section/15/enacted/en/.
[120] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-climate-energy-and-the-environment/publications/national-adaptation-framework-naf/.
[121] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-climate-energy-and-the-environment/publications/climate-action-plan-2025/.
[122] https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-climate-energy-and-the-environment/publications/national-dialogue-on-climate-action-ndca/.